

Set in 2076

Flashlights in the Dark

Commissioned by the Philharmonic Chorus of Madison

Jon D. Nelson

Begin in darkness

Moderato ♩ = c. 102

Sounds of flowing water **2** *nighttime sounds mixed with cacophonous shimmery jingling*

Soprano S

Alto S
Shadow Chorus

Baritone S

Soprano L1, L2

Alto L1, L2
Light Chorus

Tenor/Bass L

no light dark night?

Here now, a - wake with - no light (this) dark night?

Here now, a - wake with - no light Who sees be - yond this dark night?

no light Who

Here now, a - wake with - no light Who

light light who sees be - yond? Who

listen for primer tone

listen for primer tone

listen for primer tone

8

SS

This world is loud; what binds us now? Soul?

Shadow

This world is loud; what binds us now? Oh, what hol - low faith is near?

Bar S

This world is loud; what binds us now? Oh, what hol - low faith is near?

11

SS

— sees?

A L1, L2

— who sees? Who sees, — Oh Life, light; life, —

T/B L

sees? Who sees, — Oh Life, light; life, —

we are con - nected by life, —

3

SS

swell of robot sounds rocket sounds

Shadow

Look at this! This

Bar S

Look at this! This

Here, here re - mem - ber when voi - ces rang? — Look at this! This

SS

this! A cre - a - tion age! — They will build as we de - sign! look at this!

A L1, L2

this! A cre - a - tion age! — They will build as we de - sign! We can fin - ly i - mag - ine now. —

T/B L

this! A cre - a - tion age! — They will build as we de - sign! We can fin - ly i - mag - ine now. —

3

17 19

S S ten-der world. Yet lo _____ ove shines through _____ though in the night our _____ eyes

Shadow ten-der world. Yet lo _____ ove shines in the night our _____ eyes

Bar S ten-der world. Yet lo _____ ove shines _____ through _____ in the night our _____ eyes

S L1, L2 what a world! tides will start _____ to turn _____

A L1, L2 Light _____ what a world! tides will start _____ to turn _____

T/B L oh _____ what a world! _____ tides will turn _____ In _____

mp *mp* *mp* *pp*

24 26 clock ticking sounds
Andante (♩ = 72) 31

S S fail _____ a - las in time we feel _____ less _____ and less _____ Who

Shadow fail _____ a - las in time we feel _____ less _____ and less _____ Who

Bar S fail _____ a - las in time we feel _____ less _____ and less _____ Who

S L1, L2 Here, look here,

A L1, L2 Light in the night at last we rest _____ Here, look here,

T/B L night, at last we rest _____ Here, look here,

mp *pp* *mp* *pp* *mf* *mf* *pp* *pp*

33

38

S S

— can feel? Who feels these with-ered trees

A S Shadow

— can feel? Who feels these with-ered trees

Bar S

— can feel? Who feels these with-ered trees

S L1, L2

look at this! new light

A L1, L2 Light

look at this! new light

T/B L

look at this! new new light

Shin - ing in the

Shin - ing in

Shin - ing in

Shin - ing, sing-ing,

39

S S *mf* where is the sun

Shadow *mf* *mp* new rains fall on drea-ry dawns where is the sun to dry our new

Bar S *mf* *mp* new rains fall on drea-ry dawns where is the sun sun to dry our new

S L1, L2 night we bloom as au - tumn

A L1, L2 night au - tumn

T/B L night we bloom as au - tumn

— this will bloom, bloom as au tumn

45 48

S S 3/4 2/4 3/4 4/4 What are won - ders

Shadow day 3/4 2/4 3/4 4/4 What are won - ders

Bar S day for night in night; pre - ceed - ing night

S L1, L2 Here With co - lor pre - ceed - ing night ah ah ah

A L1, L2 Here With co - lor pre - ceed - ing night ah ah ah

T/B L Here for night pre - ceed - ing night in night

53 *reversed-impact sound event* 57 *f* *mf*

S S in night? Where sleeps the light? Deep

Shadow in night? Where sleeps the light? Deep

Bar S in night? Where sleeps the light? Deep

S L1, L2 Where are won - ders with-out stars? — flur - ries of co - lor in the sky — Where sleeps the light? —

A Light ah flur - ries of co - lor in the sky — light deep

T/B L ah flur - ries of co - lor in the sky — light deep

— flur - ries — Where sleeps the light? — Deep

61 *p* 66 *mf*

S S shad ows live in night. We car - ry on with flash - lights

Shadow shad ows live in night. We car - ry on with flash - lights

Bar S shad ows live in night. We car - ry on with flash - lights

S L1, L2 shad ows live in night. We car - ry on with flash - lights

A L1, L2 Light shad ows live in night. We car - ry on with flash - lights

T/B L shad ows live in night. We car - ry on with flash - lights

— shad ows live in night. We'll car - ry ours

71

68

S S

Shadow

Bar S

S L1, L2

A L Light

T/B L

we car - ry on in this: new world. Our one world

in dark ness em - brace this: new world. Our one world

car - ry on Em-brace this: new world. Our one world

we car - ry on in this: new world. Bright world.

here in dark - ness So here: em - brace this: new world. Bright world.

80

musique concrète

76

S S

Shadow

Bar S

S L1, L2

A L Light

T/B L

This Brave World

This Brave World

This Brave World

Bright, shared world

Bright, shared world

Bright, shared world

[illegible]

97 98

SS

Shadow S

Bar S

should your hands,

yours too

car - ry yours too

car - ry yours too

S L1, L2

hands,

grow wear - ry

Should your hands grow weary I'll car - ry yours

A Light

(E = Fb)

wear - ry I'll car - ry your light

T/B L

hands grow wea - ry I'll I'll car - ry ry your light yours

should your hands grow wea - ry I'll car - ry your light too

104

Eb/Bb D⁻/F D⁻(sus4)(sus9) D⁻/A Bb(add2) F⁻ 11 Db Lydian/F C⁻ Δ/Eb

S S One light, though dim, with love, can pierce can pierce night night

Shadow One light, though dim, with love, can pierce can pierce night night

Bar S One light, though dim, with love, can pierce can pierce night night

S L1, L2 One light, though dim, with love, can pierce pierce night night

A L1, L2 Light One light, though dim, with love, can pierce pierce night night

T/B L One light, though dim, with love, can pierce pierce night night

One light, though dim, dim, with love, can pierce night night

One light, though dim, with love, can pierce night night

One light, though dim, with love, can pierce night night

One light, though dim, with love, can pierce night night

115

114 *pp* *rearticulate freely in aleatoric style*

S S Who? who who who who

Shadow Who? who who who who

Bar S Who? who who who who

S L1, L2 Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

A L1, L2 Light Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

T/B L Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

Who are we? Warm hearts light Where are we? In the

124

S S

who who who who who

Night

Shadow

who who who who who

Night

Bar S

night. Who are we? Warm heartlight. Our new home. Night

Light

S L1, L2

night.

In the night. Bring light.

A L1, L2 Light

night. Who are we? Warm hearts light. Our new home. In the night. Bring light.

T/B L

night. Who are we? Warm hearts light. Our new home. In the night. Bring light.

134

S S

Light Night Light night light night light

Shadow

Light Night Light night light night light

Bar S

Light Night Light night light night light

140

S L1, L2

(Db C#) *pp*

(Light) In the night. We bring light hmm hmm hmm hmm

A L1, L2 Light

(Light) In the night. We bring light hmm hmm hmm hmm

T/B L

(Light) In the night. We bring light hmm hmm hmm hmm

articulate freely in aleatoric style

articulate freely in aleatoric style

articulate freely in aleatoric style

shimmering polytonal sound chandelier

SS

Shadow

Bar S

S L1, L2

A L1, L2
Light

T/B L

night

light

night

light

hmm

hmm

hmm

hmm

ppp

ppp

ppp

ppp

Detailed description: The musical score is written for six parts. The first three parts (SS, Shadow, Bar S) are in the upper system, and the last three parts (S L1, L2, A L1, L2 Light, T/B L) are in the lower system. The time signature changes from 2/4 to 3/4 in measure 147. The SS, Shadow, and Bar S parts have lyrics 'night' and 'light'. The S L1, L2, A L1, L2 Light, and T/B L parts have lyrics 'hmm'. The score includes dynamic markings 'ppp' and 'ppp'.